

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# Queen's Gambit Accepted for White

Recover c4 through development, build the center, and handle Black's active defenses

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# How to Use This Course

## ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

## RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

## BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

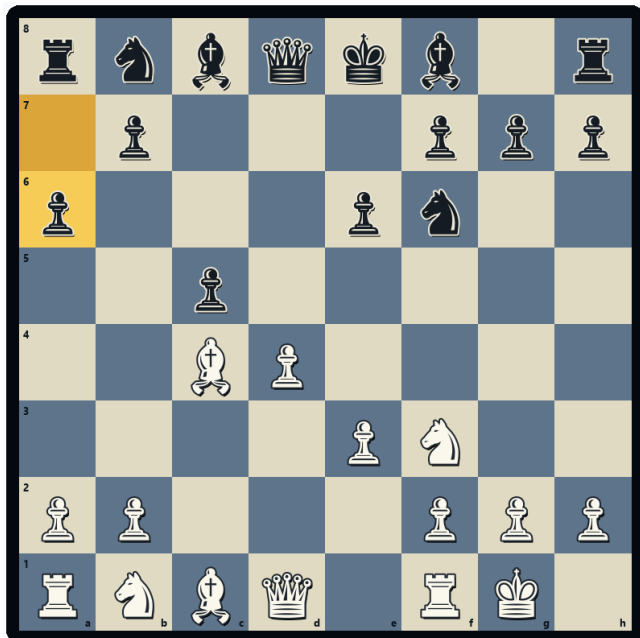
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

## Course Map

| MODULE                  | CHAPTERS |
|-------------------------|----------|
| QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED | 20       |

# 01. QGA Classical Main Line



## QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

### READ THE POSITION

White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Use Bxc4 to regain material with development.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

### MEMORY RULE

Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

# 01. Decision Framework

## QGA Classical Main Line

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep enough active pieces to use White's lead in development; exchanges are welcome only when they leave Black with a passive isolated pawn.                                                           |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Convert the opening lead by finishing development, occupying open files, and only then attacking a structural weakness. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |

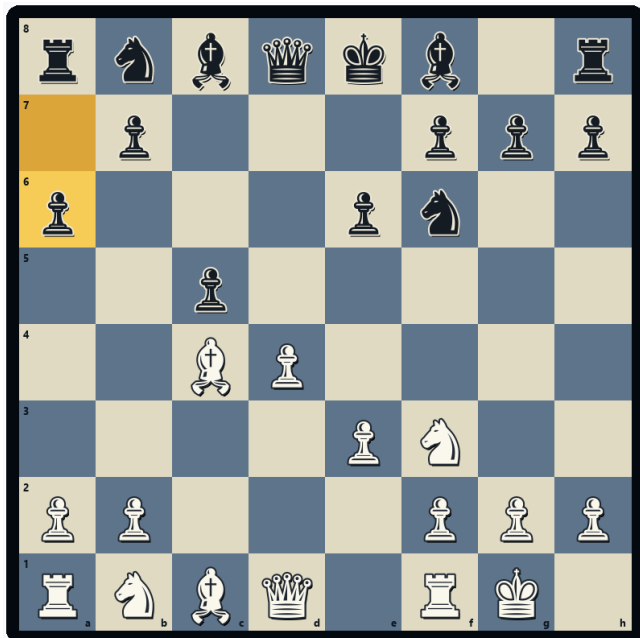
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

## 02. QGA Classical Main Line



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use Bxc4 to regain material with development.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

#### MEMORY RULE

Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

## 02. Decision Framework

### QGA Classical Main Line

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
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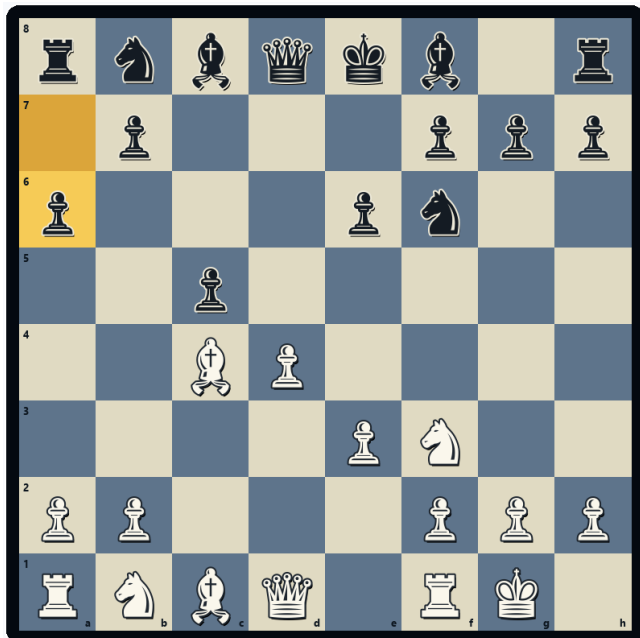
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

## 03. QGA Classical Main Line



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use Bxc4 to regain material with development.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

#### MEMORY RULE

Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

## 03. Decision Framework

### QGA Classical Main Line

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| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
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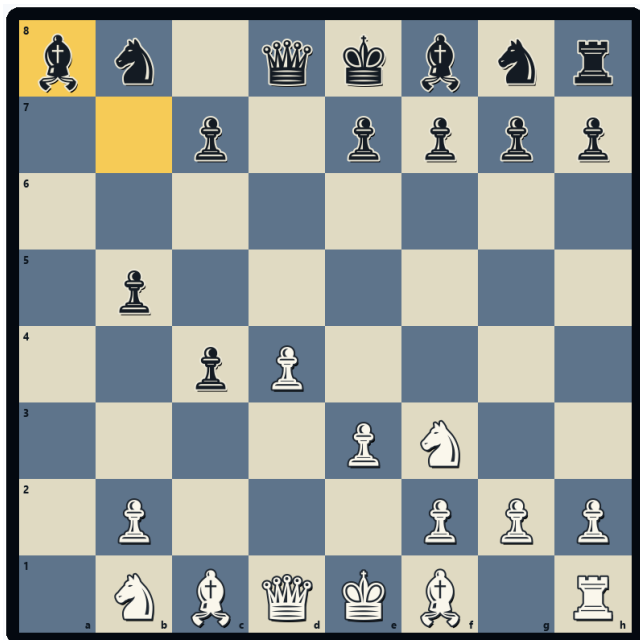
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

## 04. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Break the b5 support chain with a4.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

## 04. Decision Framework

### QGA a6 and b5 Expansion

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |

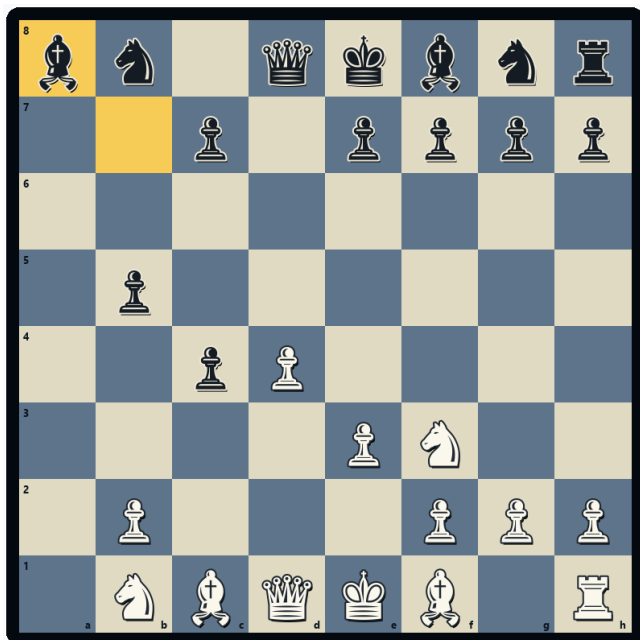
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#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

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## 05. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

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#### PRIMARY PLAN

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#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

## 05. Decision Framework

### QGA a6 and b5 Expansion

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
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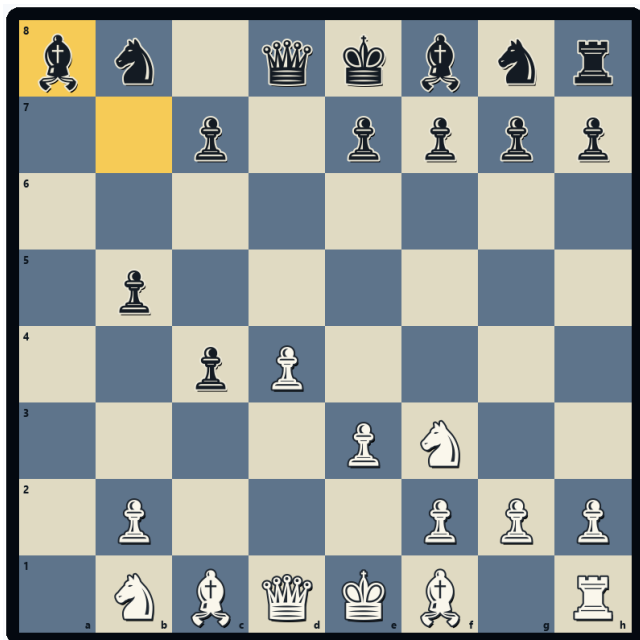
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#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

## 06. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

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#### PRIMARY PLAN

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#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

## 06. Decision Framework

### QGA a6 and b5 Expansion

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
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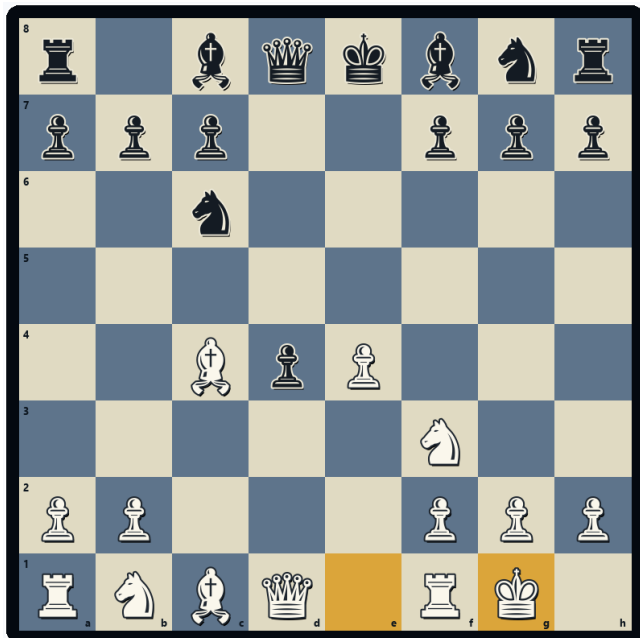
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

## 07. QGA 3.e4 Central Variation



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use the center to gain time for Nf3, Bxc4, and castling.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e5: Black attacks the center before White consolidates.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 07. Decision Framework

### QGA 3.e4 Central Variation

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.                                                                                     |
| PIECE JOB                   | Every White piece should develop behind the broad center with tempo; the center is valuable only while it accelerates the pieces.                                                                |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |
| TRADE FILTER                | Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.                                                                |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |

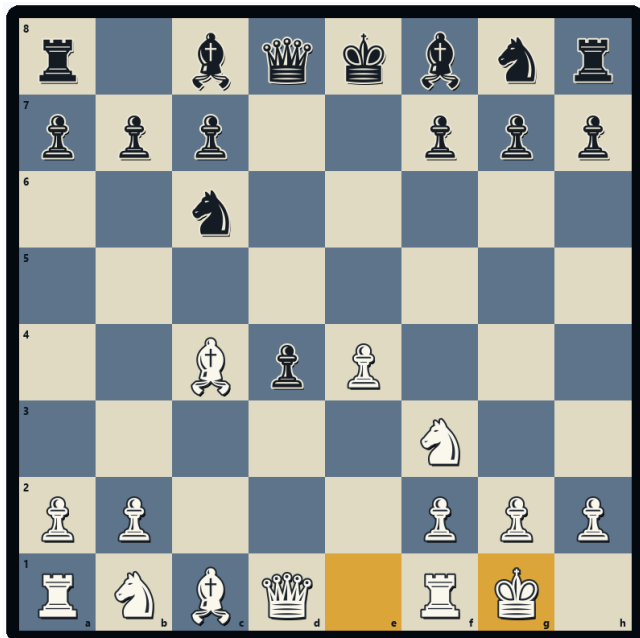
### ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 08. QGA 3.e4 Central Variation



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use the center to gain time for Nf3, Bxc4, and castling.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e5: Black attacks the center before White consolidates.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 08. Decision Framework

### QGA 3.e4 Central Variation

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.                                                                                     |
| PIECE JOB                   | Every White piece should develop behind the broad center with tempo; the center is valuable only while it accelerates the pieces.                                                                |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |
| TRADE FILTER                | Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.                                                                |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |

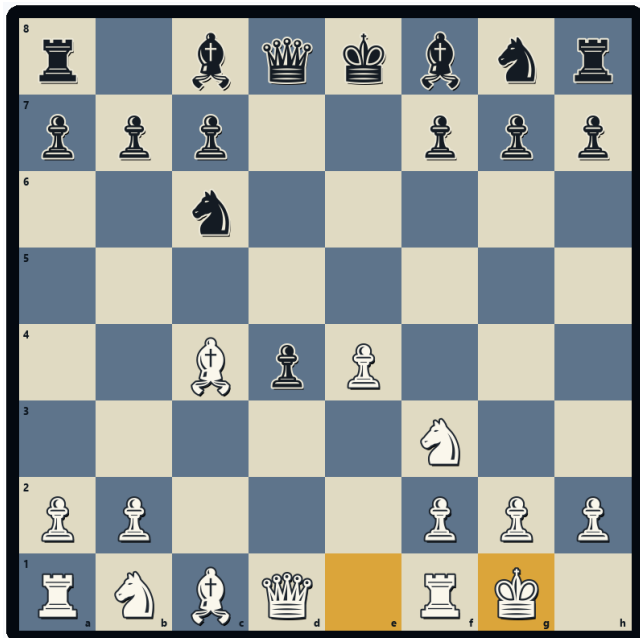
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 09. QGA 3.e4 Central Variation



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Use the center to gain time for Nf3, Bxc4, and castling.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e5: Black attacks the center before White consolidates.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 09. Decision Framework

### QGA 3.e4 Central Variation

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.                                                                                     |
| PIECE JOB                   | Every White piece should develop behind the broad center with tempo; the center is valuable only while it accelerates the pieces.                                                                |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |
| TRADE FILTER                | Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.                                                                |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |

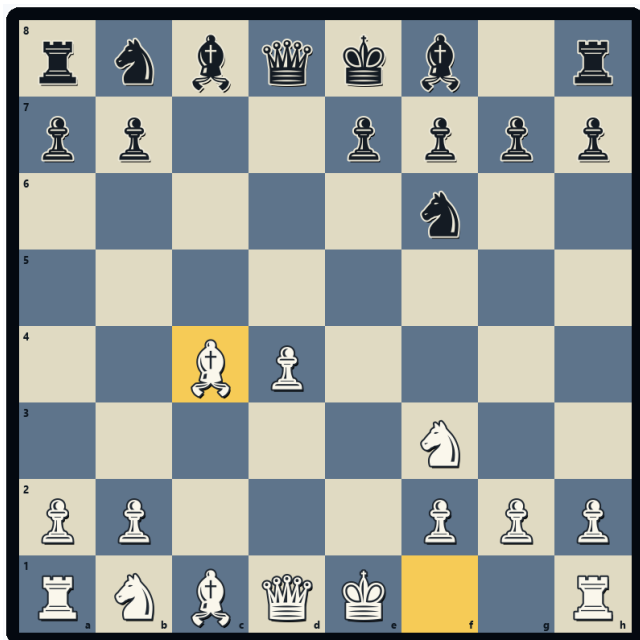
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The 3.e4 line is center plus speed: develop before the center becomes a target.

## 10. QGA Early c5 and the IQP



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Place pieces on open lines around the isolated pawn.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e6: Black blockades d5 and attacks the isolated pawn.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 c5 4. e3 cxd4 5. exd4 Nf6 6. Bxc4

#### MEMORY RULE

An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

# 10. Decision Framework

## QGA Early c5 and the IQP

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.                                                                                |
| PIECE JOB                   | Place pieces on e5, c5 and the open files around the isolated d-pawn instead of assigning every piece to its defense.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not treat the IQP as a weakness from move one.                                                                                                                                                   |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep at least one strong attacking minor piece unless the trade removes Black's best blockader or wins a concrete endgame.                                                                          |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Use the active phase to create a second weakness before simplifying into a position where d4 needs constant defense. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not treat the IQP as a weakness from move one.                                                                                                                                                   |

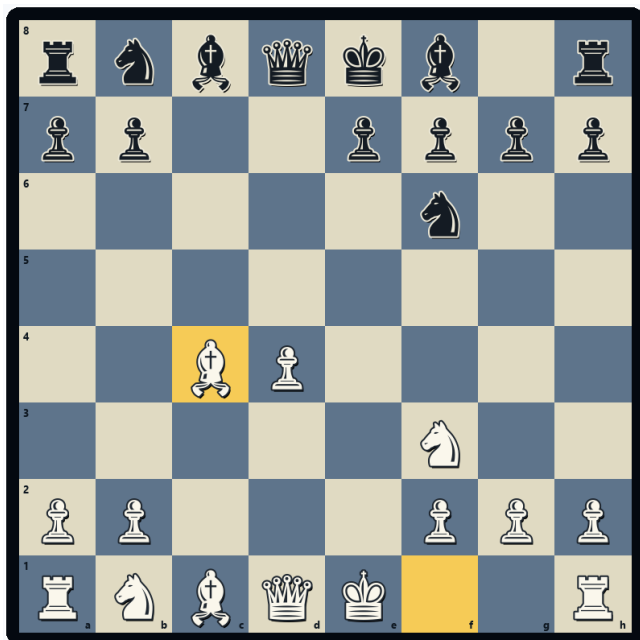
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

## 11. QGA Early c5 and the IQP



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Place pieces on open lines around the isolated pawn.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e6: Black blockades d5 and attacks the isolated pawn.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 c5 4. e3 cxd4 5. exd4 Nf6 6. Bxc4

#### MEMORY RULE

An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

# 11. Decision Framework

## QGA Early c5 and the IQP

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.                                                                                |
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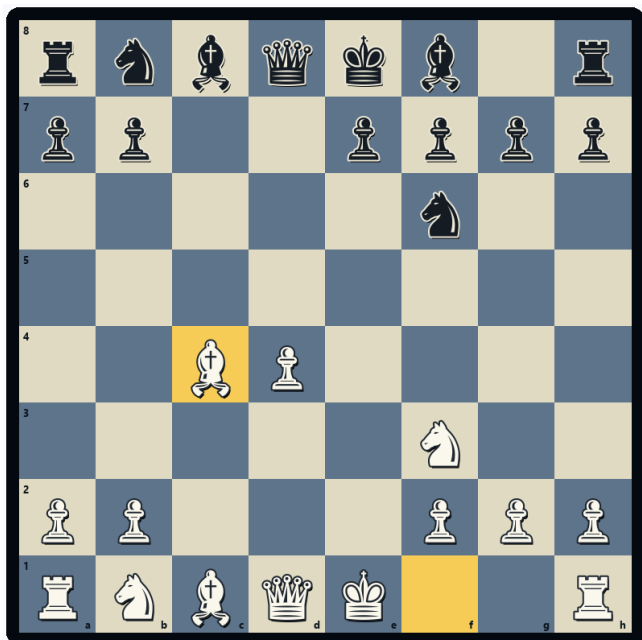
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### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

## 12. QGA Early c5 and the IQP



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Place pieces on open lines around the isolated pawn.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e6: Black blockades d5 and attacks the isolated pawn.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 c5 4. e3 cxd4 5. exd4 Nf6 6. Bxc4

#### MEMORY RULE

An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

## 12. Decision Framework

### QGA Early c5 and the IQP

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black challenges d4 immediately, and White accepts an isolated queen's pawn in exchange for open lines and activity.                                                                                |
| PIECE JOB                   | Place pieces on e5, c5 and the open files around the isolated d-pawn instead of assigning every piece to its defense.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not treat the IQP as a weakness from move one.                                                                                                                                                   |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep at least one strong attacking minor piece unless the trade removes Black's best blockader or wins a concrete endgame.                                                                          |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Use the active phase to create a second weakness before simplifying into a position where d4 needs constant defense. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not treat the IQP as a weakness from move one.                                                                                                                                                   |

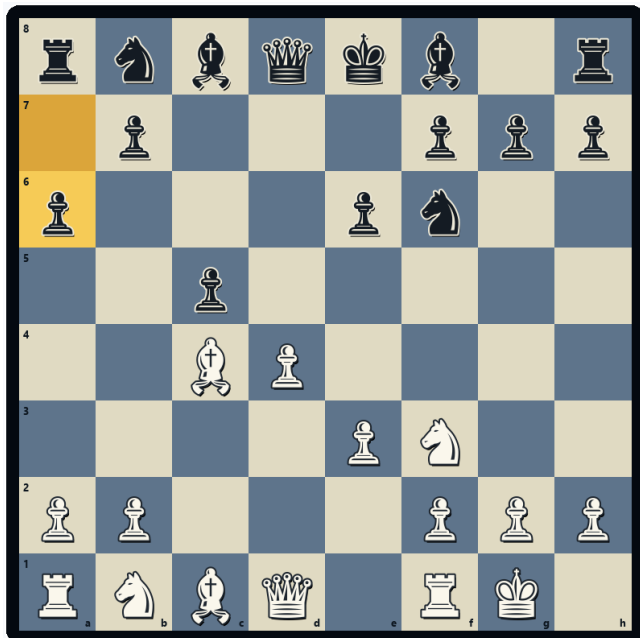
### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An IQP buys activity now and becomes a weakness later; use the time.

## 13. QGA Classical Main Line - Move-Order Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Nf3, e3, Bxc4, castle; only then choose the center.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

#### MEMORY RULE

Reconstruct the line and name the first move-order fork.

# 13. Decision Framework

## QGA Classical Main Line - Move-Order Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep enough active pieces to use White's lead in development; exchanges are welcome only when they leave Black with a passive isolated pawn.                                                           |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Convert the opening lead by finishing development, occupying open files, and only then attacking a structural weakness. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |

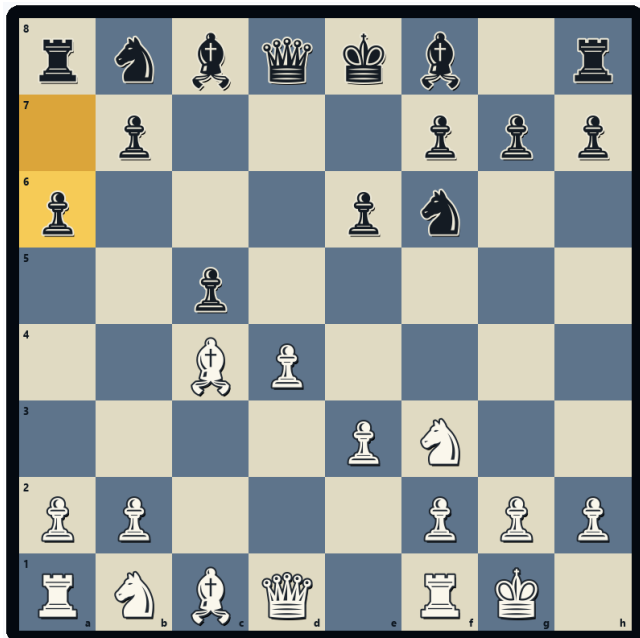
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Reconstruct the line and name the first move-order fork.

## 14. QGA Classical Main Line - Plan Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Use Bxc4 to regain material with development.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

#### MEMORY RULE

State White's plan, Black's best counterplay, and the piece that must improve first.

# 14. Decision Framework

## QGA Classical Main Line - Plan Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep enough active pieces to use White's lead in development; exchanges are welcome only when they leave Black with a passive isolated pawn.                                                           |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Convert the opening lead by finishing development, occupying open files, and only then attacking a structural weakness. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |

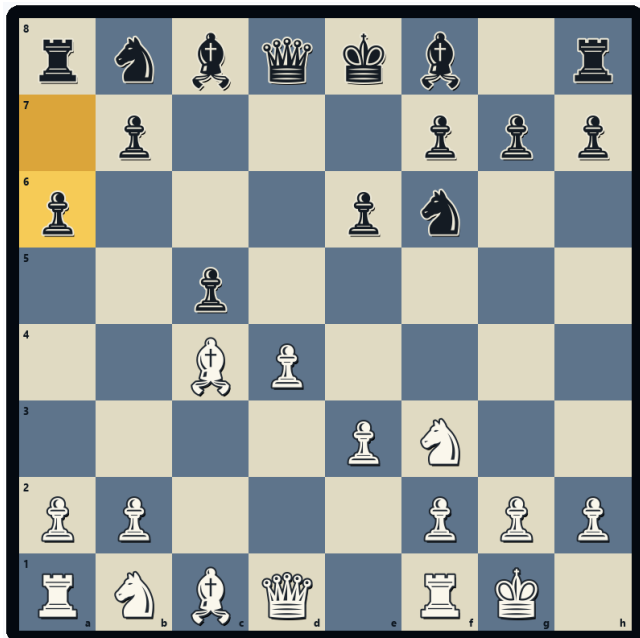
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: State White's plan, Black's best counterplay, and the piece that must improve first.

# 15. QGA Classical Main Line - Break Lab



## QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

### READ THE POSITION

White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.

### PRIMARY PLAN

Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.

### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...c5: Black strikes d4 and asks White to define the center.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

### MEMORY RULE

Calculate the central break through the first quiet position.

# 15. Decision Framework

## QGA Classical Main Line - Break Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White regains the pawn through development and reaches the central decision before Black expands with b5.                                                                                              |
| PIECE JOB                   | The c4 bishop is active but exposed; give it a useful retreat before Black's b5 expansion gains time.                                                                                                  |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |
| TRADE FILTER                | Keep enough active pieces to use White's lead in development; exchanges are welcome only when they leave Black with a passive isolated pawn.                                                           |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Convert the opening lead by finishing development, occupying open files, and only then attacking a structural weakness. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Avoid early queen checks unless they win something concrete.                                                                                                                                           |

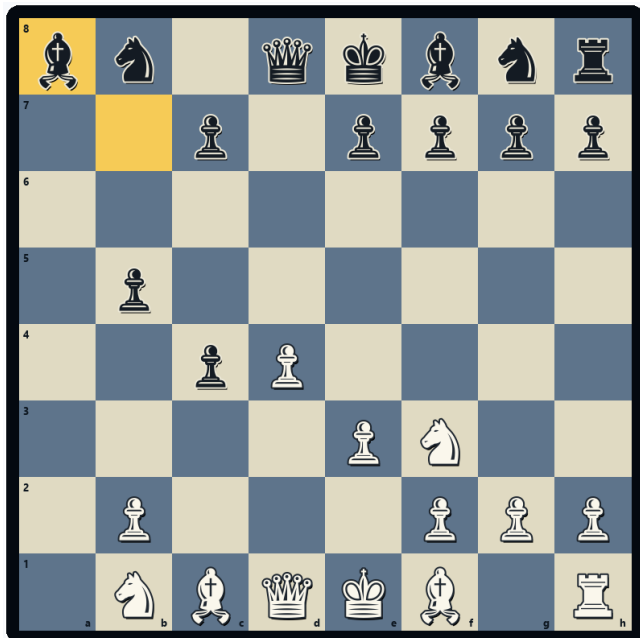
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Calculate the central break through the first quiet position.

## 16. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Trade Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

Approve a trade only after describing the resulting structure and ending.

# 16. Decision Framework

## QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Trade Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |

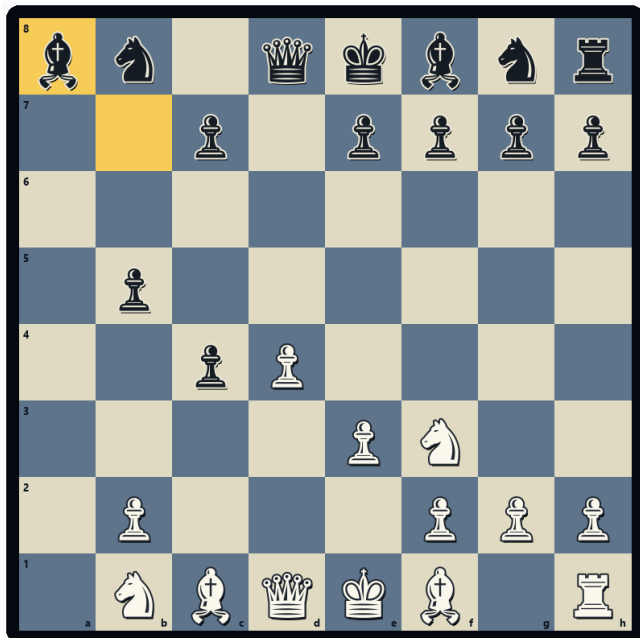
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Approve a trade only after describing the resulting structure and ending.

## 17. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Move-Order Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

When Black holds c4 with b5, attack b5 with a4.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

Reconstruct the line and name the first move-order fork.

# 17. Decision Framework

## QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Move-Order Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |

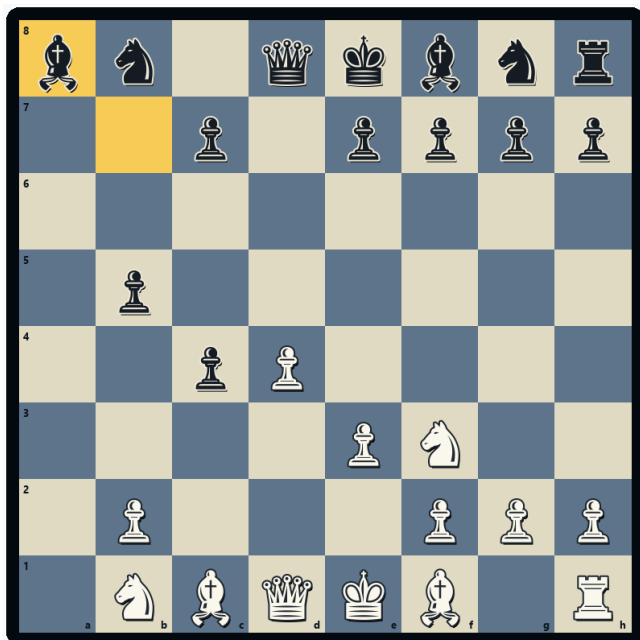
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Reconstruct the line and name the first move-order fork.

## 18. QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Plan Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Break the b5 support chain with a4.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...Bb7: Black supports the long diagonal and prepares e6.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 a6 4. e3 b5 5. a4 Bb7 6. axb5 axb5 7. Rxa8 Bxa8

#### MEMORY RULE

State White's plan, Black's best counterplay, and the piece that must improve first.

# 18. Decision Framework

## QGA a6 and b5 Expansion - Plan Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | Black tries to keep the extra c4 pawn with a6 and b5; White undermines the chain rather than chasing its front.                                                                           |
| PIECE JOB                   | White's a-rook and light bishop become useful through the open a-file and the weakened queenside diagonals.                                                                               |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |
| TRADE FILTER                | Rxa8 is a structural exchange of rooks, not an exchange sacrifice or a trick that wins material, because Black's bishop recaptures.                                                       |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Turn Black's pawn-holding tempi into faster development and pressure before the queenside pieces untangle. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not attack c4 repeatedly while b5 holds it.                                                                                                                                            |

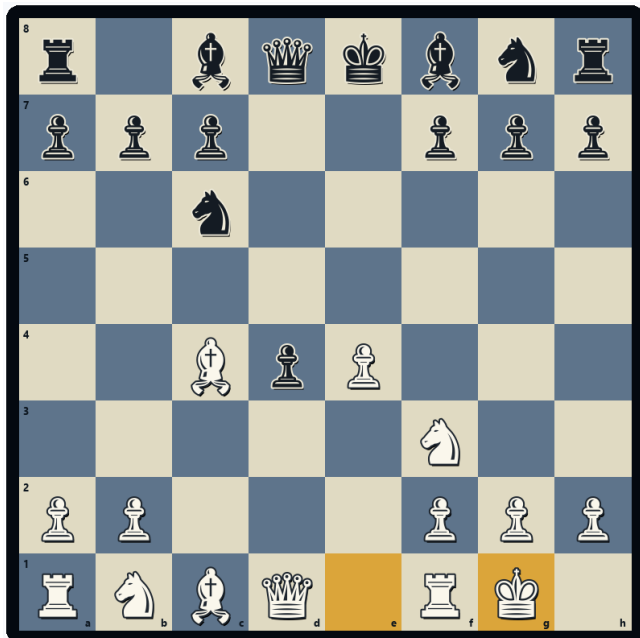
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: State White's plan, Black's best counterplay, and the piece that must improve first.

## 19. QGA 3.e4 Central Variation - Break Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e5: Black attacks the center before White consolidates.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

Calculate the central break through the first quiet position.

# 19. Decision Framework

## QGA 3.e4 Central Variation - Break Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.                                                                                     |
| PIECE JOB                   | Every White piece should develop behind the broad center with tempo; the center is valuable only while it accelerates the pieces.                                                                |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |
| TRADE FILTER                | Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.                                                                |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |

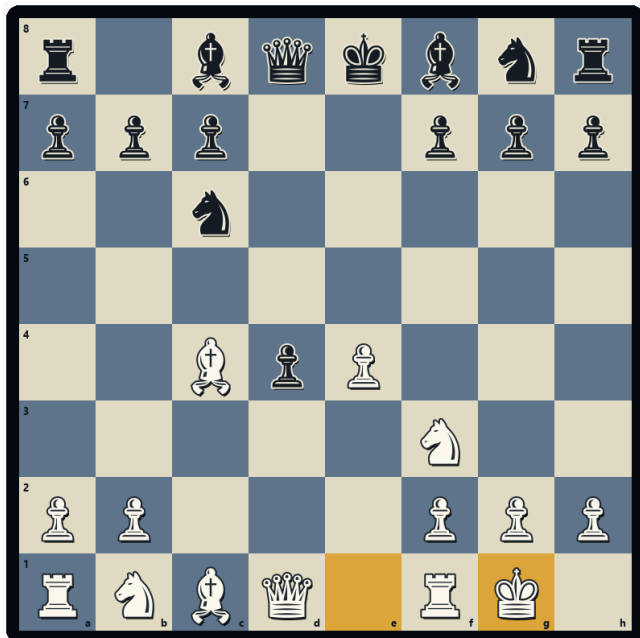
## ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Calculate the central break through the first quiet position.

## 20. QGA 3.e4 Central Variation - Trade Lab



### QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED

#### READ THE POSITION

Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.

#### PRIMARY PLAN

Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification.

#### OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

...e5: Black attacks the center before White consolidates.

#### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

#### MEMORY RULE

Approve a trade only after describing the resulting structure and ending.

## 20. Decision Framework

### QGA 3.e4 Central Variation - Trade Lab

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION | White immediately builds a broad center, accepting that accurate development is needed to justify the space.                                                                                     |
| PIECE JOB                   | Every White piece should develop behind the broad center with tempo; the center is valuable only while it accelerates the pieces.                                                                |
| TACTICAL WARNING            | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |
| TRADE FILTER                | Avoid trading the active bishop or attacking knight merely to save a pawn; activity is the compensation that justifies the setup.                                                                |
| ENDGAME FORECAST            | Castle, stabilize d4 and e4, then use the space advantage to restrict Black's pieces or create kingside pressure. Preserve the structural target or superior minor piece through simplification. |
| CLOCK RULE                  | Do not defend every central pawn at the cost of development.                                                                                                                                     |

### ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

#### NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Approve a trade only after describing the resulting structure and ending.

# Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

## FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.